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The Khān’s Country Under Threat

No one in their dreams would have thought of messing with the Khān. But perhaps, Shaybāni wasn’t just ‘anyone’.

In the winter of AD 1501, after having taken Samarkand and showing Babur out, Shaybāni was looking to take more. The Khujand River was frozen and was not very rideable. But Shaybāni Khān did cross the river and undertook a massive plunder near Shahrukhiya and Bish-kint.

The news of Shaybāni’s new deed reached Babur. He was already filled with vengeance and fire, awaiting an opportunity to knock down Shaybāni. Forgetting the smallness of his own numbers, Babur along with his men went for the villages below Khujand, opposite Hasht-yak. The weather was bitterly cold, and the wind was raging violently the whole time piercing the skin wherever exposed. Babur heard the news of a few deaths too because of the cold in that region.

Babur approached an irrigation channel with a desire to perform his ablution. Although the edges were completely frozen and were devoid of any flow, the mid-portion was not frozen because of the swift current. Babur dipped in sixteen times and was left badly bitten by the cold.

The next day, Babur and his men crossed the river from opposite Khaslar and went on through the dark to reach Bish-kint. But till then Shaybāni Khān had already gone away after having plundered the neighbourhood of Shahrukhiya.

Nuyān Kūkūldāsh Dies

In that period, Bīsh-kīnt was held by Mullā Ḥaidar’s son, ‘Abdu’ l-minān. Once upon a time, his younger son, Mūmin had visited Babur in Samarkand and had been showered with all kindness. Babur had observed him to be a worthless and dissipated person. Mūmin was a sodomite[*] too. There had